

IIIT-Kottayam
(Innovation and Startup Policy)

Education, oriented with innovations, is fundamental for achieving full human potential, developing an equitable and just society, and promoting national development. Providing universal access to quality education is the key to India's continued ascent, and leadership on the global stage in terms of economic growth, social justice and equality, scientific advancement, national integration, and cultural preservation. Universal high-quality education with innovations is the best way forward for developing and maximizing our country's rich talents and resources for the good of the individual, the society, the country, and the world.

IIIT Kottayam follows the following guidelines for promoting innovations:

- Recognizing, identifying, and fostering the unique capabilities of each student, by sensitizing teachers as well as parents to promote each student's holistic development in both academic and innovation spheres
- Emphasis on conceptual understanding rather than rote learning and learning-for-exams;
- Creativity and critical thinking to encourage logical decision-making and innovation;
- Ethics and human & Constitutional values like empathy, respect for others, cleanliness, courtesy, democratic spirit, spirit of service, respect for public property, scientific temper, liberty, responsibility, pluralism, equality, and justice;
- Promoting multilingualism and the power of language in teaching and learning;
- Life skills such as communication, cooperation, teamwork, and resilience;
- Focus on regular formative assessment for learning rather than the summative assessment that encourages today's 'coaching culture';
- Extensive use of technology in teaching and learning, removing language barriers, and educational planning and management;
- Respect for diversity and respect for the local context in all curriculum, pedagogy, and policy, always keeping in mind that education is a concurrent subject;
- Full equity and inclusion as the cornerstone of all educational decisions to ensure that all students are able to thrive in the education system;

- Faculty and entrepreneurs as the heart of the learning process – their recruitment, continuous professional development, positive working environments and service conditions;
- Continuous review of progress based on sustained research and regular assessment by educational experts;

The Startup and Innovation Policy of IIIT-Kottayam envisions an education system rooted in Indian ethos that contributes directly to transforming Nation, that is Bharat, sustainably into an equitable and vibrant knowledge society, by providing high-quality education to all, and thereby making India a global knowledge superpower as similar to the new education policy. The Policy envisages that the curriculum and pedagogy of our institutions must develop among the students a deep sense of respect towards the Fundamental Duties and Constitutional values, bonding with one's country, and a conscious awareness of one's roles and responsibilities in a changing world. The vision of the Policy is to instill among the learners a deep-rooted pride in being Indian, not only in thought, but also in spirit, intellect, and deeds, as well as to develop knowledge, skills, values, and dispositions that support responsible commitment to human rights, sustainable development and living, and global well-being, thereby reflecting a truly global citizen.

This policy will have the option to run Open Distance Learning (ODL) and online programmes, provided they are accredited to do so, in order to enhance their offerings, improve access, increase GER, and provide opportunities for lifelong learning (SDG 4). All ODL programmes and their components leading to degree will be of standards and quality equivalent to the highest quality programmes run by the IIIT Kottayam.

The Startup and Innovation policy supports a multidisciplinary institution of higher learning that offers undergraduate, graduate, and Ph.D programs, and engages in high-quality teaching and research.

The structure and lengths of degree programmes shall be adjusted accordingly. The undergraduate degree will be of 4-year duration, with multiple exit options within this period (in the future), with appropriate certifications, e.g., a certificate after completing 1 year in a discipline or field including vocational and professional areas, or a diploma after 2 years of study, or a Bachelor's degree after a 3-year programme. The 4-year multidisciplinary Bachelor's programme, however, shall be the preferred option since it allows the opportunity to experience the full range of holistic and

multidisciplinary education in addition to a focus on the chosen major and minors as per the choices of the student. An Academic Bank of Credit (ABC) shall be established which would digitally store the academic credits earned from various recognized HEIs so that the degrees from an HEI can be awarded taking into account credits earned.

The Startup and Innovation Policy of our Institute will have the flexibility to offer different designs of Master's programmes:

(a) There may be a 2-year programme with the second year devoted entirely to research for those who have completed the 3-year Bachelor's programme.

(b) For students completing a 4-year Bachelor's programme with Research, there could be a 1-year Master's programme (in the future – i.e., to be implemented based on discussions and requirements).

(c) There may be an integrated 5-year Bachelor's/Master's programme. Undertaking a Ph.D. shall require either a Master's degree or a 4-year Bachelor's degree with Research. The M.Phil. programme shall be discontinued.

The Startup and Innovation Policies of IIIT Kottayam will focus on research and innovation by

(a) setting up start-up incubation centres;

(b) Technology development centres;

(c) Centres in frontier areas of research;

(d) Greater industry-academic linkages;

Students from socio-economically disadvantaged backgrounds require encouragement and support to make a successful transition to higher education. There will also be professional academic and career counselling available to all students, as well as counsellors to ensure physical, psychological and emotional well-being

As the most basic step, all will be equipped with the basic infrastructure and facilities, including clean drinking water, clean working toilets, offices, teaching supplies, libraries, labs, and pleasant

classroom spaces and campuses. Every classroom shall have access to the latest educational technology that enables better learning experiences

All fresh Ph.D. entrants, irrespective of discipline, will be required to take credit-based courses in teaching/education/pedagogy/writing related to their chosen Ph.D subject during their doctoral training period. Exposure to pedagogical practices, designing curriculum, credible evaluation systems, communication, and so on will be ensured since many research scholars will go on to become faculty or public representatives/communicators of their chosen disciplines. Ph.D students will also have a minimum number of hours of actual teaching experience gathered through teaching assistantships and other means. Ph.D. programmes at universities around the country will be re-oriented for this purpose.

The Startup and Innovation Policy of IIIT-Kottayam will also include all leadership positions. The Heads of institutions will be offered to persons with high academic qualifications and demonstrated administrative and leadership capabilities along with abilities to manage complex situations. Leaders will demonstrate strong alignment to Constitutional values and the overall vision of the institution, along with attributes such as a strong social commitment, belief in teamwork, pluralism, ability to work with diverse people, and a positive outlook. The selection shall be carried out by the BoG through a rigorous, impartial, merit-based, and competency-based process led by an Eminent Expert Committee (EEC) constituted by the BoG. While stability of tenure is important to ensure the development of a suitable culture, at the same time leadership succession will be planned with care to ensure that good practices that define an institution's processes do not end due to a change in leadership; leadership changes will come with sufficient overlaps, and not remain vacant, in order to ensure smooth transitions. Outstanding leaders will be identified and developed early, working their way through a ladder of leadership positions.

NISP Coordinator & His Team Members

IIIT-Kottayam

cc. i) Office ii) Head of the Institute